
Phone terms you should know

Airplane mode

This [mode](#) allows you to use your phone's non-wireless functions (music, games, etc.), while disabling its wireless radio functions that are banned on airplanes during flight.

app

Software that you can download for added functionality, such as games, email apps, bar code scanners and more. Some apps are already on your phone, and more can be downloaded from your phone's app store.

Bluetooth™

A short-range wireless technology you can use to connect a device to other nearby Bluetooth-capable devices and accessories, such as headsets, speakers, printers, etc. Use Bluetooth to make handsfree calls on a headset or in your car, listen to music on wireless speakers, use a wireless mouse or keyboard, or print a document in another room. [Set up Bluetooth](#).

cellular network or mobile network

A network of radio-transmitting towers. You make calls on your phone using radio waves sent between the phone and the network towers. You also send data and access the Internet on this network. Carriers use different technologies to handle these radio transmissions (GSM, CDMA, Edge, 3G, 4G, LTE, HSPA, iDEN).

data

Information sent or received from your phone other than calls and text messages. You may use data when you access the internet, check your email, play games, use apps and more. Background tasks, such as syncing or location services, may also use data.

data usage

The amount of data your phone uploads or downloads over a network in a given period. Your phone uses your carrier's cellular network or over a Wi-Fi network. Depending on your plan with your carrier, you may be charged additional fees when your data usage exceeds your plan's monthly limits.

GPS

Global Positioning System. A global satellite-based system for determining precise locations on Earth. With GPS, your phone becomes your navigator when you're driving and your concierge when you're looking for a nearby meal, movie, or cup of coffee.

mobile hotspot

A device or app that lets you share your mobile data connection with multiple devices via Wi-Fi. You can connect different devices to your hotspot, including notebooks, netbooks, MP3 players, cameras, Smartphones, and portable gaming systems. The number of devices that can connect at one time depends on your carrier and connection speed.

NFC

Near-field communication. A wireless technology that transfers information between two compatible devices. [Tap the devices together](#) to share web addresses, contact info, apps, GPS locations and more.

notification

An alert from your phone or an app on your phone. Your phone displays icons in the status bar to notify you of new messages, calendar events and alarms. Icons can also indicate ongoing status, such as connection to a Wi-Fi network.

Play Store

Google's store where you can download apps, books, movies, and music. Choose from an assortment of free books or apps; purchase from an even larger selection.

shortcut

An icon you can add to your home screen that lets you quickly open an app. [Create shortcuts](#) for apps you use frequently.